The Well-Tempered clAIvier

VIII. Fugue in E-flat minor, a 4 (three voices and a slow one)

Piano (four voices)

Claude / Sam (subject head and guest subject: J. S. Bach, BWV 853)




11
S
A
T
B
b-flat
rit.
the dance (diminution)
♩ = 64
a tempo (♩ = 72)
S rectus, b-flat minor (VI of b-flat = G-flat)
S diminution (b-flat), the dance begins
14
S diminution (a-flat), 3 beats later
a-flat
S diminution (e-flat), 3 beats later
S rectus, a-flat minor (the subdominant)
17
false return: the slow voice inverted
♩ = 64
a tempo (♩ = 72)
S rectus over the inverted augmentation
rit.
I diminution (e-flat): the dance turns over
I augmentation x2 (the slow voice, inverted)
21
approach
head inversus (at the 5th)
head inversus (a-flat)
rit.
G.P.
♩ = 56
head
head (a-flat)
head inversus (at the 5th)


arrival: stretto over the subject at quarter speed
♩ = 70
accel. (♩ = 60)
S rectus, with its own quarter-speed augmentation
27
S
A
T
B
I inversus: the mirror of the soprano
A answer, off the beat (alto)
I inversus, off the beat (tenor)
S quarter speed (x4): the slow voice
♩ = 62 ♩ = 68
S on B-flat: its G-flat 6, the summit, lands on the tonic (b32.1)
C-flat major, pp
♩ = 56
SM rectus, C-flat major, pp, on top
31
rit.
rit.
the guest: J. S. Bach, BWV 853
BWV 853's own subject (J. S. Bach, WTC I/8): the guest
35
a-flat
rit. (♩ = 58)
♩ = 66
S rectus, a-flat minor, pp (the way back)
RI retrograde inversion x2 = the Prelude's melody, in the bass
coda
rit.
head (the last word is ours)
♩ = 46
38
I augmentation x2 under Bach's subject: our mirror, slowly
head inversus